

Important dates

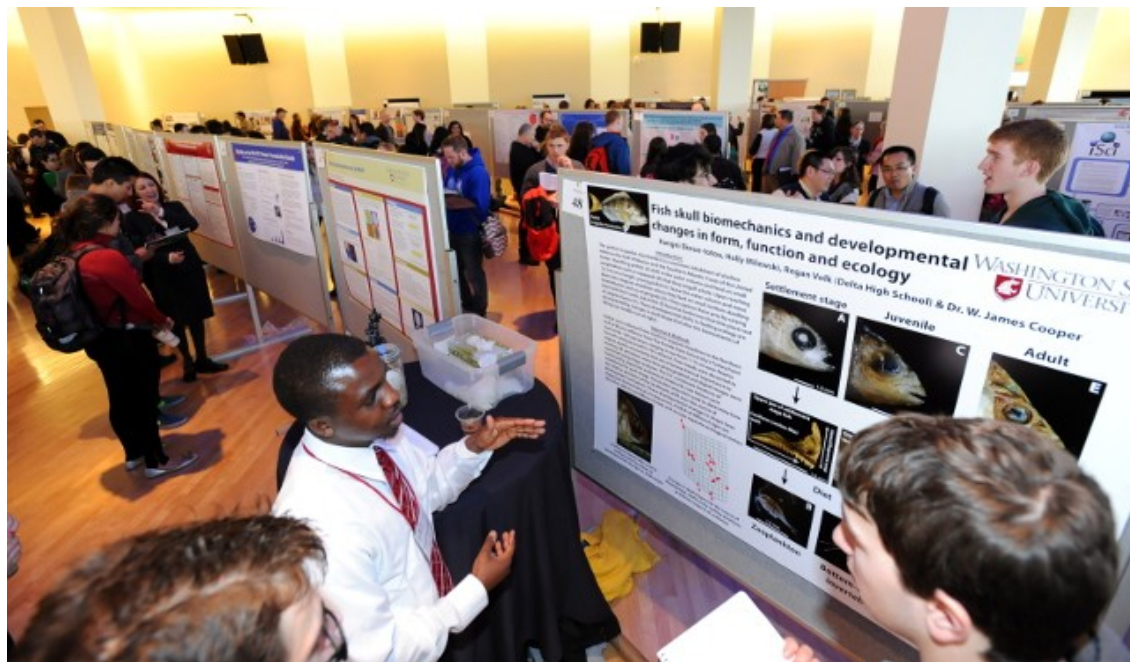
- **Friday Feb 14:** Send me all your paper progress so far, including Intro/Methods/Results/figures+tables
- **Thursday Feb 20:** Poster presentations, posters due
- **Friday Feb 28:** Complete first draft of papers due (no bullet points, all sections completed**)
- **Thursday March 13th:** oral presentations
- **Thursday Mach 13th:** final papers due

** all sections = Title, Abstract, Introduction, Methods, Results, Discussion, Acknowledgements, References, any tables and figures

All about Posters

Fish 290

Thursday May 2nd



Differences between talks and posters

Talks:

1. Happen once and are gone: each point must be instantly absorbed
2. Two-way communication is difficult and rushed
3. Audience is large: an auditorium full of people
4. Graphics must be simple- only displayed for a short while
5. Must maintain audience's attention for a set time period, or else the message is lost

Posters:

6. Can be read and re-read, are hung up for a long time
7. Excellent for two-way communication
8. Audience is small: one person or a few people at a time
9. Graphics can be more complex
10. People can read at their own pace, or only read parts of the poster

What goes into a poster?

A poster is **not a paper** in graphic form!

Think of it more as an **abstract** in graphic form.

Give just enough detail to understand the story:

- your question
- why your question is important
- what you did
- what you found
- what it means

If someone wants to know more, they can ask you!

What goes into a poster?

TRADITIONALLY

1. Title
2. Authors and Institutions
3. ~~Abstract~~
4. Introduction
5. Methods
6. Results
7. Conclusions
8. Literature Cited / Additional Info
9. Acknowledgments

Note the general layout and size of sections

[illegible]

Author, Author, and Author
Address(es)

Introduction

Blah, blah, blah.

Results

Blah, blah, blah

Conclusions

Blah, blah, blah

Materials and methods

Blah, blah, blah

Literature cited

Blah, blah, and blah. 2012. Blahing, blahing, and more blahing.
Journal of Blahology 1:1-2.

Blah, blah, and blah. 2012. Blahing, blahing, and more blahing.
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Further information

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Can try modifying this layout (but be mindful!)

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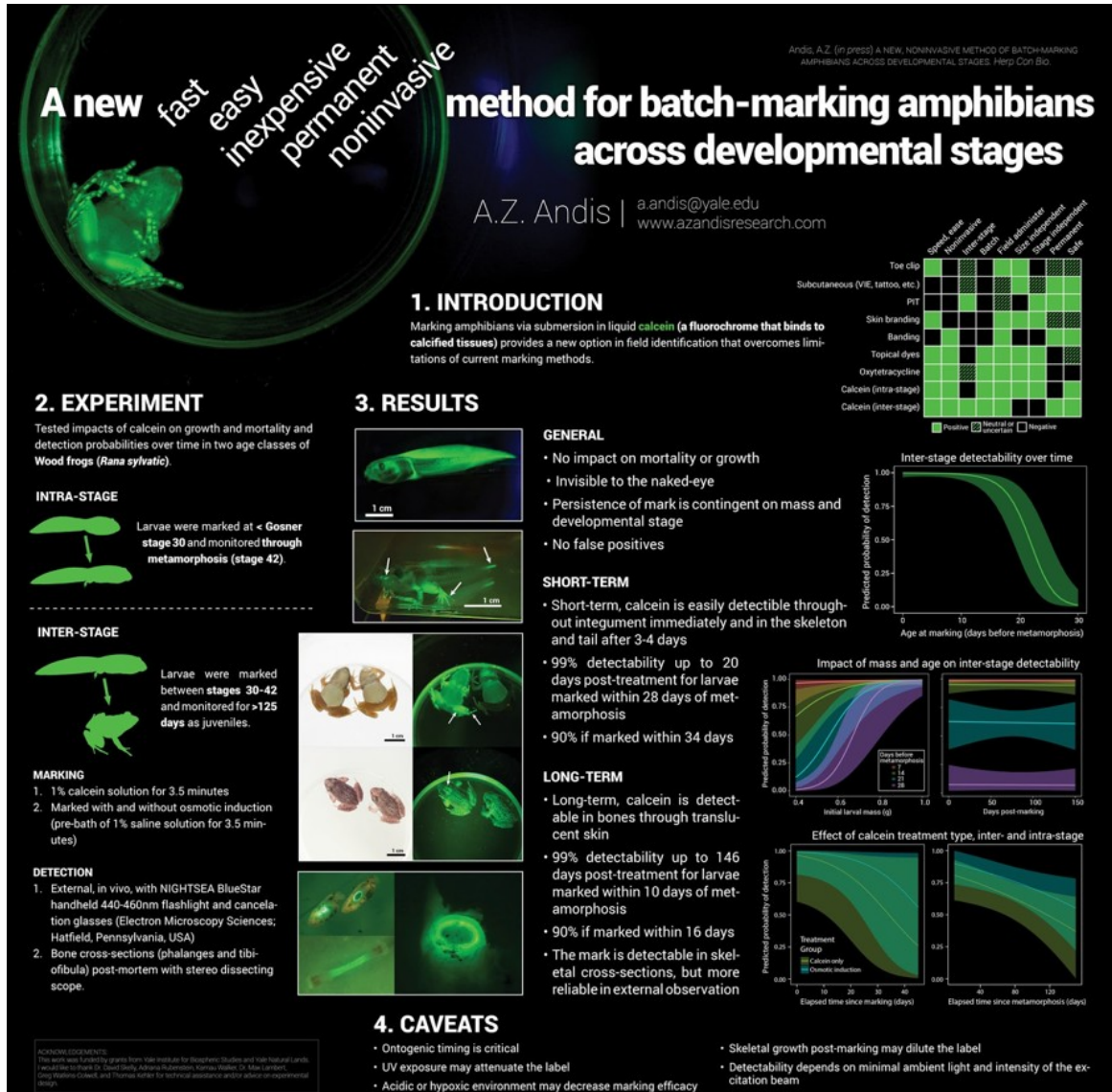
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Can try modifying this layout!



Best student poster, ASIH 2018

What is the #1 mistake people make when designing posters?

What is the #1 mistake people make when designing posters? **TOO MUCH TEXT!!**

1,958 words (28pt Times New Roman) can be crammed onto a 56 x 35" poster that has space between elements but only annoying logos for visual relief

Colin Purrington

666 Teipai Street, Posterville, PA 19801, USA

Introduction

[illegible]

Materials and methods

[illegible]

Literature cited

average word, average word, average word, average word, average
word, average word, average word, average word, average word,
average word, average word, average word, average word, average
word, average word, average word, average word,
average word, average word, average word, average word, average
word, average word, average word, average word, average word, average

Introduction

[illegible]

average word, average word, average word, average word, average word,
average word, average word, average word, average word, average word,
average word, average word, average word, average word, average word, average word,
average word, average word, average word, average word,
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average word, average word, average word, average word, average word,
average word, average word, average word, average word, average word,
average word, average word, average word, average word.

[illegible]

Acknowledgments

[illegible]

Conclusions

[illegible]

Further information

[illegible]

SPACEEXES



If I'm running around here...



DO NOT PUT LOGOS HERE.

Doing so crowds the title and visually distracts from important graphics. Put logo on your business card, not poster.

Title pitched at general audience that provides conclusion or at least hints at something interesting

Colin B. Purrington, Department of Posterology, Hudson University

Introduction

Three sentences max.

Persuade reader you have novel, interesting question(s) and hypothesis. Resist urge to use all the white space.

Materials and methods

Three sentences max.

If viewer truly wants to know gruesome details, they'll ask or email you. Sometimes adding a pic is good.

Results

Highlight your LARGE photographs, charts, maps, or in this central arena.

Don't include every graphic you've made that relates to project. Choose one. Or two. And separate graphics with plenty of white space.

If you have just one or two simple graphics, viewers will be drawn to explore them. If you have too many or they are too complicated, they will be repelled.

Annotate graphics with arrows and callout boxes so that viewer is **visually** led through how hypothesis is addressed. The goal is to enable viewers to understand the logic behind your conclusions *without you needing to be there*.

Keep font size of all text (even graph labels) as big or bigger than in rest of poster.

Conclusions

Explain why outcome is interesting. Don't assume it's obvious. Three sentences max.

Maybe include a sentence about what you plan to do next.

As for Introduction, don't feel like you need to fill the entire box.

I.e., if you retain a lot of white space you will attract more viewers. Seriously.

Literature cited

Author, J. 2012. Article title. *Journal of Something* 1:1-2.

Acknowledgments

Be brief.

Further information

Please see <https://colinpurrington.com/tips/poster-design> for more templates and tips. I'm at colinpurrington@gmail.com if you have a question or comment.

...I'll probably stop for this though!



Poster preferences very widely,
but there are a few common suggestions.

Stick to **less than 500-1000 words total!**

- That includes figure legends (if needed) and title
- 1000 words takes 5-10 minutes to read and digest
- There will be only ~3 minutes for us to evaluate you
- Sorry to break it to you – **nobody will read all the blocks of text**, so don't get attached to them. Edit ruthlessly!!
- Don't rely on text alone (unlike the body text in a paper, which is self-sufficient). Use a combination of text, graphics, and your voice to tell the story!

Poster preferences very widely, but there are a few common suggestions.

White space is that subtly-pleasing, ink-free space between letters, between words, between lines, and between blocks of text. A good amount of white space is visually inviting from afar and somehow tricks a viewer's brain into thinking more deeply about the content, increasing comprehension and satisfaction.

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© COLIN PURRINGTON

Consider white space!

White space gives relief and makes your poster more inviting.

What goes into a poster?

Title:

- Does not have to follow what is/will be written in publication
- Title needs to catch the eye, even more so than in a journal
- Can be a question
- Should not be too long- hard to read from a distance if you're walking through a crowd!

What goes into a poster?

Introduction / Background

- 150 words or less
- Aimed at somebody only marginally interested, almost certainly less informed (make it easy to follow!)
- Can and SHOULD be bulleted – recall the inverted pyramid
- Make us care: Why is your question important to study?
- Get to your hypothesis statement **quickly**
- Can reference past literature if needed, but keep it to the KEY STUDIES (2-3 total). Nobody is policing you here.

What goes into a poster?

Materials and Methods:

- 100 words **or less**
- Can use diagrams, images, arrows and text-bubbles instead of blocks of text
- Can and SHOULD be bulleted or numbered
- ENVISION, EVALUATE, ~~REPLICATE~~
Replication of methods is not as important on posters
You must decide how much detail we need to understand the story!

What goes into a poster?

Results:

- 150 words **or less**, including captions
- Graphs and images required!
- Not all results from the paper are needed to tell the story
- Use tables **only if absolutely necessary**- they take a long time to read and hard to see patterns
- Help reader interpret your figures – you should literally tell them what they should take away from it!

What goes into a poster?

Discussion Conclusions:

- 150 words **or less**
- Can/should be bulleted
- Should relate directly back to your Intro/question/hypotheses: Tell us what the answer was!
- Think about what your take-home message should be
- Good opportunity to pose future questions

What goes into a poster?

References:

- Use far fewer references than you would for a paper (only the key/most important references) – if any at all!!!!
- Can use superscripts¹ instead of in-text citations to save space.
- Give all references in a section near the bottom of your poster
- **Don't need full citations:** You can leave out titles to save space (see poster examples)
- Nobody is policing you here!

What goes into a poster?

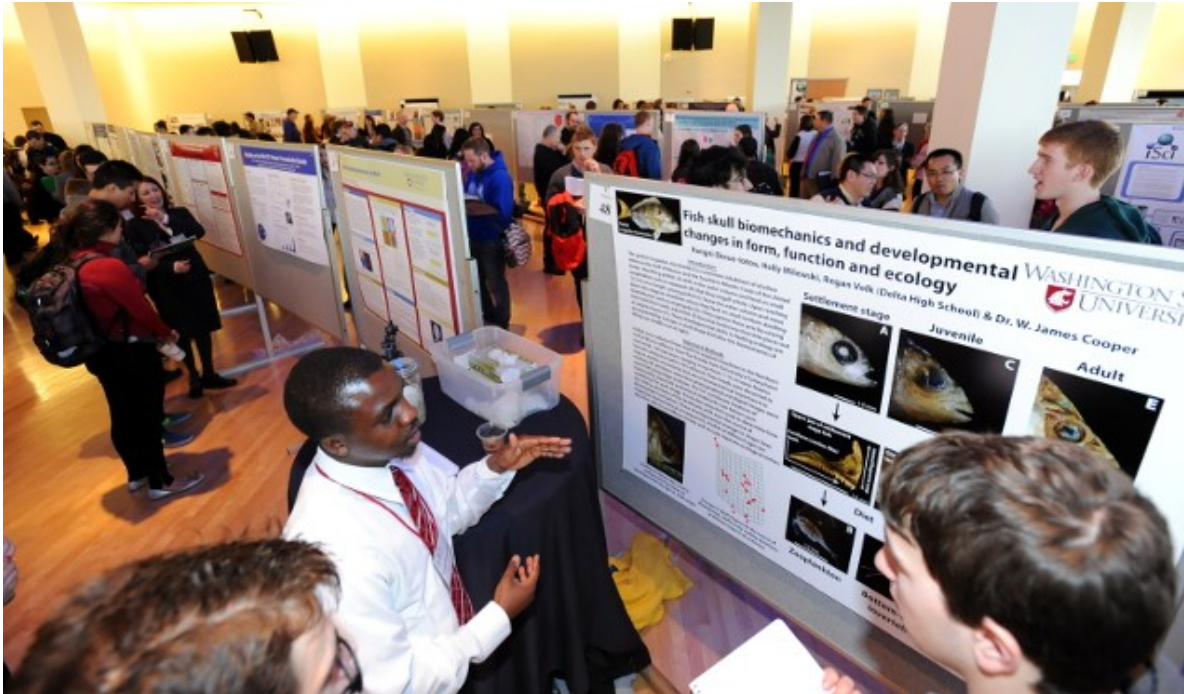
Additional Info (Optional):

- A good idea to include because posters are so brief
- Can give the website for a large ongoing project, your institution, or where you downloaded data. It's good advertising!

Acknowledgements

- If you must include, keep brief. For your Fish 290 poster – who are you even acknowledging?

Presenting the poster: what does that mean?



At a conference, while posters are displayed all day, each presenter must stand by their poster for a ~2 hour period. People will walk by and stop if they're interested!

Presenting the poster: what does that mean?

- Practice a 2-3 minute “elevator pitch”. Tell us:
 1. Big important and unanswered question
 2. Your (more specific) question
 3. How you tested it
 4. What you found
 5. What it means and how it helps solve #1
- Next, have a conversation! Be ready to answer questions, and you can ask them questions too!

Better Poster Design? Think outside the box.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SYk29tnxASs>



How to create a better research poster in less time (#...



Share

Now let's (constructively) critique other's posters.

- I will display each poster for 3-5 minutes.
- Score each poster using your comment sheets.
- Get up to take a closer look at the posters if you need to.

More helpful advice for posters:

- <https://colinpurrington.com/tips/poster-design/>
- <http://betterposters.blogspot.com/>
- <http://www.pitt.edu/~gveser/Ethics/HowToGiveAPresentation.pdf>
- <https://dynamicecology.wordpress.com/2016/03/22/the-one-big-mistake-almost-every-scientific-poster-makes/>

Assignments for today and for home

In class:

1. Begin working on your posters using PowerPoint. There are some templates on Canvas to get you started.

Outside of class:

2. By Friday at 11:59, **send me all your paper progress so far.**
3. You will be assigned peer reviews of other student papers due on Thursday next week
4. Continue working on **posters** on your own. Poster session on Thursday.